Emphasis weight in the pause ladder

Narration that knows what matters.

Every rung of the pause ladder keyed on a glyph or a boundary, so a deck's key claim was paced exactly like its footnote.

01 · The problem

Every beat was the same length.

- Punctuation set the pause
  - A comma bought 200 ms, a period 550. The glyph decided, never the meaning.
- Boundaries set the rest
  - A paragraph, a slide and a section each got a flat constant.

KEY INSIGHT

Nothing ever asked which words mattered.

02 · Emphasis buys time

A bold phrase holds a beat.

Net revenue retention reached 118% — that single number moved the year, so the narration waits before moving on.

- The author pressed the button
  - `**bold**` is the whole signal. No model, no inference.

KEY INSIGHT

If everything is held, nothing is.

03 · The closing beat

The coda used to be silent.

A trailing quote is lifted into its own cell, outside the stage every body walker reads.

- Measured, not guessed
  - 53 of 161 committed decks carry one.
- Spoken, and held
  - The beat lands in the shared webpage, which pauses after the last line too.

KEY INSIGHT

A slide's punchline was not paced badly. It was missing.

04 · One beat per passage

A long insight lands once.

- The cue that ends it holds
  - A passage spanning four sentences gets one beat after it, not four inside it.
- A short phrase is unchanged
  - A bolded claim starts and ends in the same sentence.

KEY INSIGHT

Holding everything is holding nothing, one sentence at a time.

05 · The limits

Best-effort, and never wrong.

- A repeated phrase is skipped
  - The same words twice, and neither is marked.
- The hold is capped
  - Bolding every line buys no stall.

KEY INSIGHT

A missed beat sounds like yesterday. A misplaced one sounds like a defect.

06 · Where it applies

Captions, read-aloud, exported player.

- One formula, three consumers
  - The estimate, the live Studio and the baked deck space cues identically.
- The hold sits between cues
  - A synthesized clip carries no pause the engine invented.

KEY INSIGHT

An unweighted deck is timed exactly as it was before any of this existed.